



DLU AI-NATIVE UNIVERSITY · COURSE AUTHORIZING GUIDE

Designing Courses with the **DLU Course Exchange Format v1.3**

A step-by-step guide for course authors — no coding or JSON knowledge required.

WHY THIS MATTERS

One file that fully describes your course

Every course you design — goals, lessons, readings, quizzes, grading rules and final exam — is captured in a single, portable file. A guided tool builds this file for you, step by step, while you focus only on the educational content.



Portable

Move a course between universities, departments or terms without losing anything.



Reviewable

Colleagues and the technical team can check your course before it goes live.



Re-editable

Save your progress any time and pick up exactly where you left off.



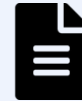
Use the Course Builder — never touch the file directly



DLU Course Builder

RECOMMENDED

- A guided, web-based wizard — answer questions on screen, no file editing
- Built-in checks stop you from missing required information
- Bilingual: switch between Italian and English at any time



Direct JSON editing

TECHNICAL TEAM ONLY

- Same end result, but requires understanding the file's structure
- Used for bulk edits or system integrations, not day-to-day authoring



Our guiding example for this presentation

Throughout this guide we build one small course from scratch: “Introduction to Digital Marketing” — a 2nd-year undergraduate business course. Every screen shown uses real entries from this example, so you can see exactly what to type at each step.

How a course is built, level by level



Course

Title, description, level, audience, credits...



Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)

What students will be able to do by the end



Sections (Lessons)

Each section = one lesson or module, with its own teaching plan



Pages & Content

Pages inside each lesson, filled with text, videos, quizzes...



Final Examination

Optional cumulative assessment at the end of the course

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STEP 1 OF 9

Course Information

Title

The official name students and faculty will see.

Description

3–5 lines: what it covers, why it matters, who it's for.

Level

Undergraduate or Graduate.

Target audience

e.g. “2nd-year Business students”.

Category & difficulty

Discipline area and Beginner / Intermediate / Advanced.

Language, credits, course code

Auxiliary identifying details.

Prerequisites, delivery mode

Online, blended or in-person; any required prior courses.

REQUIRED

REQUIRED

REQUIRED

REQUIRED

REQUIRED

OPTIONAL

OPTIONAL



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

TITLE

Introduction to Digital Marketing

LEVEL · AUDIENCE

Undergraduate · Business students, 2nd year

CATEGORY · DIFFICULTY

Management · Beginner

DESCRIPTION

Introduces digital marketing channels, SEO basics, and how to measure campaign performance.

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STEP 2 OF 9

Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)

A CLO states what students will be able to DO by the end of the course. Write each one as: an action verb + content + context.

BLOOM'S TAXONOMY — PICK THE RIGHT VERB

Remember list, define	Understand explain, describe	Apply use, implement	Analyze compare, examine	Evaluate judge, assess	Create design, build
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 **Every course needs at least 3 CLOs, and no more than 8.**

Each CLO needs a description and a Bloom level. Try to vary the levels across your CLOs rather than using the same one repeatedly.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

CLO-1

Remember

List the main digital marketing channels and classify them as paid, owned, or earned.

CLO-2

Apply

Apply on-page SEO principles to optimize a sample web page.

CLO-3

Evaluate

Evaluate a digital campaign's performance using key engagement metrics.

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STEP 3 OF 9

Bibliography & Grading Scheme



Optional — but strongly recommended for an academically complete course.

BIBLIOGRAPHY

List the textbooks, articles and readings for the course. For each: type (primary/additional/supplementary), title, authors, and a link if available.

GRADING SCHEME

Define the total points, a letter-grade scale (A–F with percentage ranges), and how points are split across quizzes, assignments and the final exam.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

BIBLIOGRAPHY (1 of 3 entries)

Primary · Book
“Principles of Marketing”, Kotler & Armstrong, 18th ed.

GRADE SCALE (sample)

A	B	C	F
90–100%	80–89%	70–79%	< 70%

ASSESSMENT CATEGORIES

- Quizzes — 30 pt (30%)
- Assignments — 20 pt (20%)
- Final exam — 50 pt (50%)

Policies & Course Resources



Optional — sets expectations for students before the course starts.



Policies

Academic integrity, late-submission rules, attendance, accessibility accommodations, netiquette.



Course Resources

Tutoring hours, discussion boards, guest seminars, and links to extra materials.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

LATE POLICY

10% penalty per day late, up to 3 days.

ATTENDANCE

Not mandatory but strongly recommended.

TUTORING

Office hours every Tuesday, 15:00–16:00.

DISCUSSION BOARDS

Enabled — one post per lesson required.

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STEP 5 OF 9

Sections, Blueprint & MLOs

Each Section is one lesson or module. Inside it, the Blueprint sets the teaching plan: pedagogical strategy, how much time it takes, and a media mix (the balance of text, video, quizzes...). The Blueprint also holds the section's MLOs.

WHAT IS AN MLO?

A Module Learning Objective is a CLO “zoomed in” to one lesson — more specific, still with a Bloom level and (optionally) an assessment method.



Every section needs at least 1 MLO, each with a description and Bloom level.

New sections can be added freely — there is no maximum.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

SECTION 1

Digital Marketing Channels Overview

Pedagogical strategy: Active Learning · Duration: 60 min

MEDIA MIX

Text

Image

Video

Quiz

MLO-1

Analyze

Classify digital channels using the PESO framework (Paid, Earned, Shared, Owned).

Assessment method: multiple-choice quiz

Pages & Content Components

Each Section has one or more Pages. Each Page is built from content components — choose from 13 types:



Text



Image



Video



Audio



Quiz



Assignment



File



Callout



Flashcard



Glossary



Code



Lab



Embed



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

TEXT COMPONENT

“Marketing Outbound vs. Inbound — Outbound reaches for the customer (TV spots, banners); Inbound lets the customer find you (SEO, blog posts).”

QUIZ COMPONENT

A company posts SEO-optimized blog articles to attract visitors for free. This is:

- a) Outbound marketing
- b) Inbound marketing ✓**
- c) Paid marketing

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STEP 7 OF 9

Final Examination



Optional — turn it on only if the course ends with a cumulative exam.

- **Logistics**

Format (online, oral, mixed...), duration, attempts, open/closed book.

- **Objectives**

Link CLOs to the exam, each with a weight — should add up to 100%.

- **Methods**

The activities that make up the exam (13 types, e.g. multiple-choice, case study, oral).

- **Rating**

Maximum points, passing threshold, and the grading rubric.



If enabled, the exam needs a title and at least 1 verification method.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

TITLE

Final Examination — Introduction to Digital Marketing

FORMAT · DURATION

Mixed · 90 minutes

OBJECTIVES

CLO-1 (30%) · CLO-2 (35%) · CLO-3 (35%)

METHODS

Multiple choice (50 pt) + Case study (50 pt)

PASSING THRESHOLD

60%



STEP 8–9 OF 9

Author Information & Finishing Up

Institutional email

Used to identify the course owner in the system.

REQUIRED

Name with title

e.g. “Prof. Maria Rossi” — shown to students and reviewers.

REQUIRED

WHEN YOU'RE DONE (OR NOT YET!)



Save Draft

Available at any step. Download your progress, even if incomplete, and keep working later.



Download Final JSON

From the review screen, once you're happy with the course.



Load File

Open a previously saved draft — or a finished course — to keep editing it.



EXAMPLE — Introduction to Digital Marketing

EMAIL

g.conti@stuniversity.edu

NAME WITH TITLE

Prof.ssa Giulia Conti



Ready to export

3 CLOs · 3 Sections · 3 MLOs · 4 Pages · 9 Components · Final exam enabled

↓ Download JSON

Constraints checklist

Item	Constraint
Course title, description, level, target audience, category, difficulty	Required for every course
Course Learning Outcomes (CLOs)	Minimum 3, maximum 8
Each CLO	Needs a description and a Bloom level
Each Section	Needs a title and a pedagogical strategy
Each Section's MLOs	At least 1 MLO per section (no maximum)
Each MLO	Needs a description and a Bloom level
Author email & name	Required
Bibliography, Grading, Policies, Resources	Optional, but recommended
Final Examination	Optional — if enabled, needs a title and ≥ 1 verification method

REVISING AN EXISTING COURSE

Already have a course? Load it, edit it, done.



1. Load File

Open the existing course file (complete or partial) in the Course Builder.



2. Edit any step

The wizard re-populates every field — jump to any step and make changes.



3. Re-export

Download the updated JSON and hand it to the technical team.

RECAP

Nine steps, one file, zero JSON editing.

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Course Info

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CLOs

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Bibliography

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Policies

5

Sections & MLOs

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Pages & Content

7

Final Exam

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Author

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Review & Export

Questions? Reach the DLU technical team before your first export.